Weekly Progress Report

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I. Overview:

This week, I continued my project on creating a Meta Ads audience for an EdTech company's Digital Marketing course. After finalizing the core targeting criteria in Week 1, I focused on refining the audience, building Custom and Lookalike audience ideas, and planning the ad creative and budget so that the campaign gives a better return on investment.

II. Tasks Completed and Milestones Achieved:

1. Audience Refinement:

- Reviewed the Week 1 audience and removed overlapping and low-intent interests to avoid wasted spend.
- Split the audience into three ad sets for testing: Students (18-24), Early-career professionals (25-30) and Freelancers / small business owners (25-35).

2. Custom and Lookalike Audiences:

- Planned Custom audiences from website visitors, video viewers and Instagram / Facebook page engagers.
- Planned 1% and 2% Lookalike audiences of India, based on past course enquiries and buyers.

3. Ad Creative and Budget Planning:

- Drafted ad copy with a clear hook and call to action, for example: *"Start a career in Digital Marketing. Learn SEO, Social Media and Ads. Enrol Now."*
- Chose creative formats: a short Reel, a single-image ad and a carousel showing course modules, and prepared a simple test-budget split across the three ad sets.

Task	What was done	Outcome / Milestone
Audience cleanup	Removed overlapping interests and merged similar ones	Cleaner, more focused core audience
Ad set structure	Created 3 audience segments based on age and profession	Ready for A/B testing in the campaign
Custom audiences	Defined sources: website, video views, page engagement	Warm audience plan ready for retargeting
Lookalike audiences	Defined 1% and 2% Lookalike audiences	Plan to scale reach to similar high-intent users
Ad copy and creatives	Wrote copy and selected 3 ad formats	Ad content ready for review

III. Challenges and Hurdles:

1. Audience Overlap:

- **Nature:** Interests like Digital marketing, SEO and Online advertising were overlapping, so ad sets could compete against each other.
- **Approach:** Checked audience overlap, merged similar interests and kept each ad set focused on one clear group.

2. Balancing Audience Size:

- **Nature:** Too many filters made the audience too narrow, and too few made it too broad.

- **Approach:** Added and removed filters step by step while watching the Audience Size indicator, until it showed a healthy middle range.

3. Writing Effective Ad Copy:

- **Nature:** It was difficult to write a short message that attracts both students and working professionals.
- **Approach:** Created separate copy for each segment, focusing on jobs for students and skill growth for professionals, and took mentor and peer feedback.

IV. Lessons Learned:

- A smaller, well-defined audience usually gives better results than a very broad one, because the money is spent on people who are actually interested.
- Custom and Lookalike audiences help in reaching people who are already close to buying the course.
- Testing is important: separate ad sets and creatives show clearly what works, instead of guessing.
- Skills gained: audience analysis, overlap checking, ad copywriting and basic budget planning. Problem-solving by changing one thing at a time will help me in future campaigns too.

V. Next Week's Goals:

- Build the full campaign structure (campaign, ad sets and ads) in Meta Ads Manager and finalize the creatives.
- Define the key metrics to track, such as Reach, CTR, CPC and cost per lead, and prepare a simple report format.
- Share the audience and ad plan with mentors / peers and improve it based on their feedback.

VI. Additional Comments:

Week 2 helped me move from basic audience selection to a more practical campaign plan. Discussions with peers were useful, especially for improving ad copy and removing audience overlap. I am confident about completing the project in the coming weeks.